

March Madness Bracket — Scoring & Rules

Overview

Welcome to our class March Madness bracket challenge! Points are awarded by round, with an **extra upset bonus in Round 1**.

Scoring by Round

- **Round 1 (64 teams):** 1 point per correct pick
 - **Upset bonus:** +1 extra point *in Round 1 only* for correctly picking an upset where the **lower seed beats the higher seed, excluding 8 vs. 9 games**.
- **Round 2 (32 teams):** 2 points per correct pick
- **Round 3 — Sweet 16:** 3 points per correct pick
- **Round 4 — Elite Eight:** 4 points per correct pick
- **Round 5 — Final Four:** 5 points per correct pick
- **Round 6 — National Championship:** 6 points per correct pick

“Third round = 3 points” and so on—i.e., the point value increases by 1 each round.

Upset Definition (Round 1 only)

- An **upset** is when the **numerically larger seed** defeats the **numerically smaller seed** (e.g., a 12 beats a 5).
 - **No upset credit** for 8 vs. 9 matchups.
 - Each correctly predicted eligible upset in **Round 1** earns **+1 extra point**.
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Quick Examples

Example A — Round 1 upset you called correctly

- You picked a **12** to beat a **5**, and it happened.
- Points: **1 (correct pick) + 1 (upset bonus) = 2 points**

Example B — Round 1 correct pick that is not an upset

- You picked a **2** to beat a **15**, and it happened.
- Points: **1 point** (no upset bonus)

Example C — Sweet 16 correct pick

- You picked the winner of a Sweet 16 game correctly.
 - Points: **3 points**
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Bonus Points

- **Beat-the-Instructor Bonus:** If your total score **beats my score**, you earn **+1 bonus point**.
 - **Placement Bonuses (class leaderboard):**
 - **1st place:** +5
 - **2nd place:** +4
 - **3rd place:** +3
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«««< HEAD ## Results

```
library(tidyverse)
library(kableExtra)
results <- read_csv('march_madness_results.csv')
results |>
  kable()
```

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Name,Round 32,Upset Points,Sweet 16,Elite 8,Final 4 ,Championship

Game,Champion,Total

Akula, Suhaan,23,1,24,12,12,10,6,88
Palam, Kai,26,1,24,18,8,5,0,82
Yhu, Logan,27,1,26,15,8,5,0,82
Poloskey, Parker,24,0,26,18,8,5,0,81
Kwasniak, Babe,23,1,24,15,8,5,0,76
Bartosh, Braden,25,2,20,12,4,5,6,74
Duong, Ylan,23,2,24,15,8,0,0,72
Chalk,24,0,24,15,8,, ,71
Collins, Ethan,24,2,22,15,8,0,0,71
Teuscher, Kayla,25,1,22,15,8,0,0,71
Jacknewitz, Marisa,26,3,22,6,8,5,0,70
McCauley, Ireland,24,2,16,9,8,5,6,70
O'Keefe, Brendon,23,1,24,12,4,5,0,69
Owen, Jacob,23,1,22,12,4,5,0,67
Yun, Grace,25,1,20,12,4,5,0,67
Gohlich, Tyler,21,1,22,12,4,5,0,65
Ellis, Ethan,22,0,18,12,12,0,0,64
Carmichael, Harry,25,0,18,12,4,5,0,64
Treacy, Keagan,25,2,18,9,4,5,0,63
Coffman, Carter,24,2,20,12,4,0,0,62
Bekele, Brook,23,0,22,12,4,0,0,61
Lai, Sean,26,2,20,6,4,0,0,58
Nordby, Kristian,25,1,16,12,4,0,0,58
West, Jared,24,1,24,9,0,0,0,58
Wurst, Riley,24,0,22,12,0,0,0,58
Catapano, Tyler,25,1,20,8,0,0,0,54
Hyder, Robert,25,2,18,9,0,0,0,54
LTC Pleuss,24,1,20,9,0,0,0,54
Scott, Ryan,20,0,20,3,4,5,0,52
Fellows, Gunnar,21,1,20,9,0,0,0,51
Russell, Owen,21,1,16,12,0,0,0,50
Zick, Christina,24,1,16,9,0,0,0,50
Burtner, Elijah,22,2,12,6,4,0,0,46
Leja, Gabriel,21,3,16,6,0,0,0,46

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,Round 32,Upset Points,Sweet 16,Elite 8,Final 4 ,Championship

Game,Champion,Total,Final 4 Remaining,Champ Remaining

Yhu, Logan,27,1,26,, , ,54,4,1
Jacknewitz, Marisa,26,3,22,, , ,51,2,0
Palam, Kai,26,1,24,, , ,51,3,1
Poloskey, Parker,24,0,26,, , ,50,3,1
Duong, Ylan,23,2,24,, , ,49,4,1

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West, Jared,24,1,24,, ,49,2,0
Akula, Suhaan,23,1,24,, ,48,3,1
Collins, Ethan,24,2,22,, ,48,3,1
Kwasniak, Babe,23,1,24,, ,48,4,1
Lai, Sean,26,2,20,, ,48,3,1
O’Keefe, Brendon,23,1,24,, ,48,4,1
Teuscher, Kayla,25,1,22,, ,48,4,1
Chalk,24,0,24,, ,48,3,
Bartosh, Braden,25,2,20,, ,47,4,1
Catapano, Tyler,25,1,20,, ,46,3,0
Coffman, Carter,24,2,20,, ,46,4,1
Owen, Jacob,23,1,22,, ,46,4,1
Wurst, Riley,24,0,22,, ,46,2,0
Yun, Grace,25,1,20,, ,46,3,1
Bekele, Brook,23,0,22,, ,45,2,0
Hyder, Robert,25,2,18,, ,45,3,1
Treacy, Keagan,25,2,18,, ,45,4,1
LTC Pleuss,24,1,20,, ,45,3,1
Gohlich, Tyler,21,1,22,, ,44,3,0
Carmichael, Harry,25,0,18,, ,43,3,1
Fellows, Gunnar,21,1,20,, ,42,1,0
McCauley, Ireland,24,2,16,, ,42,4,1
Nordby, Kristian,25,1,16,, ,42,2,0
Zick, Christina,24,1,16,, ,41,3,1
Ellis, Ethan,22,0,18,, ,40,4,1
Leja, Gabriel,21,3,16,, ,40,3,1
Scott, Ryan,20,0,20,, ,40,4,1
Russell, Owen,21,1,16,, ,38,3,1
Burtner, Elijah,22,2,12,, ,36,3,1
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